

the dot to account for this. Searching for `t.re` will return the answer `tyre` and `tire`. Remember, it will also return `t#re` but chances of somebody writing that are close to zero.

## Star \*

Stars will match zero or more of the previous items. Items can be characters or even regex expressions. So if you are searching for a name say `Robbie` which is also spelled as `Robie`, you can use the expressions `Rob*ie`. This will match `Robbie`, `Robbbbbbie` and any more `b`'s that can be put in there. So basically, it will look for instances where the previous character is repeated, in this case `'b'` is repeated and return that as the answer to this search. It will also return `Robie` as the answer because it matches even zero instances.

## Dot Star .\*

This is a lethal combination and extremely useful. It means 'get everything'. So a dot will search for any character that can replace the dot and the star will repeat the previous item ad infinity. In this case the previous item is a dot so that regex will be repeated and the dot will look for any character that can fit in the string. So if you have various subcategories in your product portfolio but all fall under one category like `men's wear`. So subcategories could be:

- `menswear/t-shirt`
- `menswear/shirts`
- `menswear/jeans`
- `menswear/trousers`

A regex `menswear/.*` will return all the above categories i.e. it will get everything.

## Plus Sign +

Similar to the Star, this also matches to the previous item. Again, the item could be a regex or a character. The big difference being, there has to be at least one repeated item present. For this reason, it's rarely used. Continuing the previous example, the expression `Rob+ie` will return `Robbie`, `Robbie`, `Robbbie` and so on but not `Robie` because there has to be at least one repeated character.